01 | CCEs | DESK REFERENCE

CCE Message Checklist

Use this checklist when you write, read, or forward work direction.

> **When the Administrative Directive applies**
> Written expectations, changes, decisions, and work reminders from leadership must include CCEs 1–5, plus CCE 6 when a source document applies. Greetings and replies that only confirm receipt do not need the CCEs.

Element	What to check
1. What is changing or being asked	Is it clear who needs to do what, and by when?
2. Why / Why it is changing	Does the message explain why?
3. Who owns it and who decides	Does it name who does the work and who decides?
4. What is not changing	Does it say what stays the same?
5. What to do if it is unclear, and when you will hear back	Does it say who to contact and when to expect a reply?
6. Where this lives (whenever applicable)	Does it point to the right form, policy, or guide?

Before you send or forward a message

Do not change the action, reason, deadline, audience, or decision-maker. You can reword for clarity, but the direction must stay the same. If a fact is missing, ask for it instead of guessing.

When you receive direction

Repeat it back to confirm you understood:

> *"I understand that I need to _____ by _____. I am responsible for _____. I still need to confirm _____ with _____."*

> **Last check**
> Could the reader tell you what to do next, by when, and who to ask for help? A link to a document can help, but the message itself still needs to explain the direction.

Source: Communicating CLEAR training, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.